



FRONTLINE HEALTHCARE EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

Welcome note from the CEO

Dear Frontline Family,

Welcome to the heart of Frontline Healthcare, where compassion meets purpose, and every team member is seen, valued, and empowered.

I'm Millicent Ferguson, the founder of this vision turned reality, and I am genuinely honored to have you as part of our growing family. First and foremost, I want you to know this: You belong here! You were chosen not only for your skillset and experience but because your spirit aligned with something much greater, a mission rooted in love, dignity, and caring!

Frontline Healthcare was born out of a deep calling to do more. To create a space where care is not just clinical, but soulful. Where individuals with developmental disabilities, aging adults, and every individual we serve are treated as whole beings...mind, body, and spirit. But I couldn't do this alone. That's why you're here!

Each one of you is a vital thread in this tapestry we're weaving. A team of changemakers, healers, and everyday heroes. Whether you're in direct care, administration, or support, your contribution matters deeply. And in return, it is my mission to foster an environment where your voice is heard, your well-being is a priority, and your growth is championed.

This handbook was created to support and guide you, but never to limit you. Inside, you'll find the structure that holds us steady and the values that make us shine...integrity, respect, inclusivity, and above all, love!

Let's walk this journey with intention. Let's lead with kindness. Let's remember that behind every task, every shift, every care plan, there is an individual who depends on us. When we serve from the heart, we change lives.

Our mission is simple:

"At Frontline Healthcare, we are dedicated to fostering an inclusive environment where every individual feels valued and empowered. We take a thoughtful, well-rounded approach to health, ensuring our services support the physical, emotional, and everyday needs of the people we serve."

Thank you for believing in this vision. Thank you for showing up. Thank you for being part of something powerful.

With so much love and gratitude,
Millicent Ferguson
Founder & CEO, Frontline Healthcare LLC

Purpose of the employee handbook

This Employee Guidebook is a guideline to explain Frontline Healthcare operating policies and procedures; however, it is not all-inclusive. This Employee Handbook will be updated periodically. Frontline Healthcare reserves the right to change the terms of the policies written in this handbook without prior notice and/or consent of its employees. Employees will be notified when updates have been made to this handbook.

Any final interpretations of or changes to this manual and herein contained shall be at the discretion of the CEO.

Consumer Rights

Bill of Rights for Individuals with Developmental Disabilities include, but are not limited to:

- A. The right to be treated at all times with courtesy and respect and with full recognition of their dignity and individuality;
- B. The right to an appropriate, safe, and sanitary living environment that complies with local, state, and federal standards and recognizes the persons' need for privacy and independence;
- C. The right to food adequate to meet accepted standards of nutrition;
- D. The right to practice the religion of their choice or to abstain from the practice of religion;
- E. The right of timely access to appropriate medical or dental treatment;
- F. The right of access to necessary ancillary services including, but not limited to, occupational therapy, physical therapy, speech therapy, and behavior modification and other psychological services;
- G. The right to receive appropriate care and treatment in the least intrusive manner;
- H. The right to privacy, including both periods of privacy and places of privacy;
- I. The right to communicate freely with persons of their choice in any reasonable manner they choose;
- J. The right to ownership and use of personal possessions so as to maintain individuality and personal dignity;
- K. The right to social interaction with members of either sex;
- L. The right of access to opportunities that enable individuals to develop their full human potential;
- M. The right to pursue vocational opportunities that will promote and enhance economic independence;
- N. The right to be treated equally as citizens under the law;
- O. The right to be free from emotional, psychological, and physical abuse;
- P. The right to participate in appropriate programs of education, training, social development, and habilitation and in programs of reasonable recreation;
- Q. The right to participate in decisions that affect their lives;
- R. The right to select a parent or advocate to act on their behalf;
- S. The right to manage their personal financial affairs, based on individual ability to do so;
- T. The right to confidential treatment of all information in their personal and medical records;
- U. The right to voice grievances and recommend changes in policies and services without restraint, interference, coercion, discrimination, or reprisal;
- V. The right to be free from unnecessary chemical or physical restraints;
- W. The right to participate in the political process;
- X. The right to refuse to participate in medical, psychological, or other research or experiments.

Violation of any Residents Rights will lead to immediate disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment.

Staff Rights

Personal Support Professionals and all employees who are involved in the consumers' care, but due to a perceived conflict with ethics, cultural values, religious or personal beliefs may request not to participate in any aspect of a consumer' care. FLH will make reasonable effort to approve such request, as long as the use of any alternative approaches will not negatively impact the consumer' s care and will not constitute a violation the consumer' rights.

At-will Employment

Employment with this agency is not for a specified term and is at the mutual consent of the employee and the agency and either party may terminate the relationship at any time with or without cause.

Equal employment policy

FLH complies fully with local, state and federal affirmative action laws. If at any time an employee feels like the employee was not given equal treatment in accordance with the provisions of the law, the employee should contact the Human Resources to file a complaint.

American with Disabilities Act

FLH complies with the American with Disabilities Act and will reasonably accommodate qualified individuals with a disability in order to make it possible for them to perform the essential functions of their job duties, unless doing so causes a direct threat to these individuals or others in the workplace.

Immigration law compliance

In compliance with the Immigration Reform and control Act, each new employee as a condition of employment, must complete Form I-9 and present documentation establishing identity and employment eligibility in the United States.

Criminal Background Checks

All employees are required to provide authorization for release of information for criminal background checks from the Ohio Bureau of Criminal Investigation and other local, state and federal law enforcement agencies. Applicants with a criminal conviction may not be eligible for employment at FLH per state licensure requirement #5123:2-3-06. Human Resources can provide employees with the list of disqualifying felonies upon request.

Employees who have been convicted of any criminal activity during their time of employment with FLH must notify the Human Resources department in writing within 10 working days of the conviction. Employees who fail to report any conviction will be disciplined and/ or subject to dismissal.

Tuberculosis Test/ Hepatitis B

Newly hired employees have the option to complete the two-steps Tuberculosis screening test within their first thirty days from date of hire. **Employees who have a justifiable medical reason that prevents them from receiving the TB screening must provide a note from a physician. Employees who need to provide evidence of a negative chest x-ray, the employees will be responsible to the cost associated taking the x-ray.**

Hepatitis B is an optional immunization offered to FLH employees. This immunization is free of charge to employees. Employees who elect not to receive the immunization at the beginning of their employment, but are interested in this immunization later on during the time of their employment should contact the Human resources department.

Employees who fail to complete any portion of the TB testing or Hepatitis B process due to a fault of their own will be responsible for the cost to retake the test or complete the process. FLH will not be responsible for any portion of the cost of the TB testing or the Hepatitis B process, if an employee resigned or is terminated before the completion of these processes.

Employee training requirements

All new staff must complete orientation training prior to beginning work at any site and complete all relevant trainings within 15 days after finishing orientation. As a condition of continued employment, all employees are required to maintain current certifications by attending all scheduled training sections. Failure to do so may result in corrective action up to and including termination of employment.

Driving Policy

Due to the nature of FLH business, all Residential Support Specialists are required to have a valid Ohio Driver's license with a suitable driving record for transportation purposes as a condition to maintain their employment with FLH. Driving eligibility is determined by agency standards and can change at any time with or without employees' consent.

All personnel who are required to operate a motor vehicle whether personal or agency owned while duty must maintain driving privileges. Human Resources must be notified immediately if a driver receives a moving violation, is involved in a car accident or driver's license is suspended. Failure to do so may result in disciplinary action and include up to termination of employment.

Employees are permitted to transport consumers in their personal vehicles; however, they must submit proof of adequate automobile insurance coverage to the Human Resources department prior to employment. All employees must maintain valid automobile insurance all times.

Employees must have reliable means of transportation while on duty in order to fulfill transportation needs. These needs include but are not limited to taking consumers to medical appointments, errands and groceries. Employees must come to work with their vehicle.

Vehicles Operation

Authorization to operate FLH owned vehicles is at the discretion of the agency. The use of agency owned vehicles are essential for day-to-day business purposes. Employees who operate agency owned vehicles are expected to exercise care, follow operating instructions and safety guidelines. Agency vehicles should only be used for official business needs and shall be operated within the limits of traffic laws.

All vehicles before use must be inspected to insure they are operating properly. The supervisor must be notified immediately if a vehicle or any of its part is defective, presents damages or appears inoperable. Careless, negligent and/or unsafe operation of FLH owned vehicles may result in corrective action, up to and including termination of employment.

Employees will be responsible for any fines incurred during the operation an agency vehicle. FLH will take necessary steps to recover any expenses incurred due to an employee's careless or negligent operation of agency owned vehicles. Safe vehicle operating standards prohibits the use phone and personal gadgets while driving. If it is necessary to make/return a call when operating a vehicle, the employee must pull over at a safe place. Failure to follow this policy will subject the employee to disciplinary action and include up to termination of employment.

Accidents

Employees who drive during business hours should take all precautions to avoid getting into an accident. When involved in an accident, the employee should:

- Call the police while still on the scene of the accident and obtain a police report. Notify the authorities regardless of the nature of the accident.
- Seek immediate medical assistance if needed: request to be transported to the emergency room.
- Report the accident to immediate supervisor while still on scene of the accident.
- Complete Unusual Incident Report and/ or Employee Incident Report form immediately.

An employee who is involved in a vehicle accident will not be permitted to return to work until all post-accidents steps have been completed. Post-accident steps include meeting with Human Resources and taking a post-accident drug test. Failure to report an accident while on duty will subject the employee to disciplinary action up to and including termination.

Employment categories

Employees are classified into different categories to determine their employment status. Based on labor laws, employees are either exempt or non-exempt; however, based on their schedule agreements they are classified as either full-time, part-time, seasonal or PRN. Refer to Human Resources for explanation regarding employment status and benefit eligibility.

- Full time: Employees who signed a schedule agreement to work thirty-eight hours or more each week.
- Part Time: employees who signed a scheduled agreement of thirty-seven hours or less.
- Seasonal employees are those hired as interim replacement or to temporarily supplement the staffing needs. They are not eligible for agency offered benefits.
- PRN employees are those who work on an "as needed" basis and are required to work a minimum of eight hours per month. Failure to pick up an eight-hour shift during a period of thirty days (30) days will be considered a voluntary resignation. PRN staff members are not eligible for benefits.
- Independent Contractors & Consultants
 - Independent contractors and consultants are not Company employees, but rather self employed professionals whom we hire for specific projects. Unlike employees, they do not operate under Company direction, and control their own methods, materials and schedules. They are not eligible for Company benefits.

Full time employees who do not work their signed schedule will have their employment status changed to part time regardless of their schedule agreement and will lose their benefits eligibility. Benefits eligibility for new employees begins after (90) days of continuous full-time employment. Employees who wish to change their employment status must communicate this desire to the Human Resources department and sign another shift agreement.

Performance appraisal policy

We believe that continuous work performance monitoring is a good tool to praise employees for their excellent work and a way to address areas where improvement is needed. All new employees and current employees who receive a promotion/transfer are subject to ninety (90) days probationary period at the end of which a performance review shall be completed. If employee failed meet the required job performance, they are subject to another 90 days extension or termination. Another performance evaluation shall be completed quarterly thereafter. During the evaluation meeting, goals will be set for the coming quarter and the progress on the goals will be discussed throughout the year.

Work schedule

Employees are assigned a fixed schedule at a specific site(s); however, based on the agency's staffing needs employees may be required to work at sites other than the assigned one(s). Staff reassignment may occur periodically when deemed necessary to meet some staffing needs. Failure to comply fully with this policy will result in a disciplinary action and include up to termination of employment.

Shift switch policy and alternative shift agreement

There are times where an employee might need a day off work to take care of personal needs. In this circumstance, the employee may elect to switch shift with another employee. The following conditions must be met in order for a shift switch to be approved:

1. The shift switch must fall under the same period. Employee may check with immediate supervisor to determine what constitutes pay period.
2. The alternative shift agreement must be completed with the signatures of the two staff who are switching shifts.
3. The immediate supervisor must be notified about the switch and must sign the alternative shift agreement and turn it in to the Program Director.

Failure to comply with the above policy may result in the shift switch being denied and employees subject to corrective action. Repeated violation of this policy will result in termination of employment.

Timesheets

Employees have the responsibility to accurately record their arrival time and departure time on the timesheets. All corrections/changes must have an explanation associated to them. Tampering with shift starting and shift ending time constitute a falsification of documentation and any employee who has been found guilty of falsifying documentation shall be reprimanded accordingly.

Holiday Pay

Nonexempt employees shall be compensated at a rate of a time and half for hours worked during FLH elected holidays. Holidays worked hours shall be considered for the purposes of overtime calculations. FLH observes the following holidays:

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| 1. New Year Day | 2. Memorial Day |
| 3. Independence Day | 4. Labor Day |
| 5. Thanksgiving Day | 6. Christmas Day |

Payroll

Payday is bi-weekly on Fridays. Employee who enroll in payroll direct deposit have their wages automatically deposited in their accounts. Employees who do not enroll in payroll direct deposit should pick up their checks at the office by noon on payday or the checks will be mailed to their home address. Employees who do not enroll in payroll direct may do so any time during their employment by contacting the Human Resources Department.

The agency takes reasonable steps to ensure employees receive accurate payment; however, payroll processing errors might result in payment miscalculations. If an employee believes that his/her wages are lesser than expected, the employee should report the payment error to the Payroll department. The employee will be required to complete a pay adjustment form and an investigation will be conducted to determine if an error occurred during payroll processing. The following actions are likely to happen after the investigation:

1. If an employee receives lower payment than expected due to payroll processing errors FLH will make reasonable effort to issue the employee a hard copy checks of the difference.

2. If an employee receives lower payment than expected due to failing to submit payroll documents by the payroll deadline, a pay adjustment will be made during the following pay period.

If an employee believes that he/she was paid more than expected, the employee should report the payment error to the Payroll department. An investigation will be conducted with regard to overpayment and if it is determined that a payment error occurred, the employee will notify in writing and a mutually acceptable pay adjustment arrangement will be made. Failure to report a suspected overpayment may result in corrective action.

Personal time

FLH rewards full-time employees with the opportunity to accrue personal time hours. Full time employees can earn 1.85 hours every pay period that they work at least seventy-six hours. The maximum that can be accrued per year is limited to forty hours. Personal time is capped at forty-eight hours. Personal time may only be used for emergency situations and other purposes as approved by Human Resources.

In order for an employee to use personal time for time off work due to an emergency, the employee must notify immediate supervisor eight (8) hours prior to the beginning of the shift or submit documentation proving the absence and submit a pay adjustment form.

Vacation

Full time employees will have their vacation added as follows:

1. 40 hours available after one (1) year of full time employment.
2. 40 hours available after two (2) years of full time employment.
3. 80 hours available after three (3) years of full time employment.

Vacation hours are deposited on the anniversary date.

Only full-time employees can earn vacation hours and those who fail to work full time hours and have their status changed as a result will lose all accrued vacation hours. Employees can accrue up to two hundred forty (240) hours of vacation and will not be able to accrue vacation hours when they reach the cap. Direct compensation is not provided in lieu of taking earned vacation.

FLH requires at least fifteen (15) days notification for vacation request to be approved and at least thirty (30) days notification for a request totaling seven (7) shifts or more. FLH will make reasonable effort to grant employees vacation; however, it is understood that that due to staffing needs and the time when the request is being submitted, FLH will not be able to honor a vacation request. Employees are expected to report to work in case vacation request is denied. It will be

recorded as no-call/ no-show if an employee fails to report to work when a request for vacation has been denied and as a result the employee may be terminated.

An employee who resigns will receive compensation for available vacation hours given that the employee has completed at least one year of continuous full-time employment with FLH, has submitted a resignation notice at least twenty-one (21) days prior to the last day of work and has worked through the notice. Vacation time will be paid out the next pay period.

Employee Information Change

Human Resources department maintains confidential and employees' personal information. Employees are responsible to notify the Human Resources Department of any changes in name, marital status, number of dependents, home address, emergency contacts, and telephone number. Change of Information forms are maintained at the office.

Resignation and Separation of Employment

Employment with FLH is based on mutual consent and either party has the right to terminate employment at-will, with or without cause.

In the case of voluntary separation of employment, employees are asked to submit a written resignation notice to their supervisor three weeks in advance in order to receive compensation for their unused vacation hours. This notice should include the date submitted, the effective date and the specific reason for leaving. Vacation time will be paid out as long as the employee has submitted the required notice, has worked through the notice and has been employed full-time by FLH for at least one year. Employees who take leave after submitting their resignation notice will not receive compensation for their unused vacation hours unless where prohibited by the law.

An employee whose employment has been terminated will receive his/her final paycheck on the following regular pay day, provided that the employee returns all FLH owned belongings. Final payment will be a live check and FLH reserves the right to withhold the final paycheck if the employee is not in good standing with the agency. The final paycheck will be mailed to the employee's address of residence on file unless a written notarized request to do otherwise has been sent to the Human Resources department at least three days prior to payday.

Return of Agency Property

Employees must return all FLH owned property in satisfactory condition immediately upon request, voluntary or involuntary termination of employment. The agency may take all action

deemed appropriate to recover or protect its property including withholding employees' paychecks and/or taking legal actions.

Call-Off Policy

Employees who are unable to report to work as scheduled must report their absence to their immediate supervisor at least twelve (12) hours prior to the beginning of their shift. Employees who do not notify their immediate supervisor within the established time frame will not be permitted to take any paid personal time to cover the shift they called-off.

In emergency situations where circumstances do not permit twelve hours advanced notice, an employee may complete a pay adjustment form and send it with the appropriate documentation to Human Resources department for approval. Failure to do so in a timely manner may result in the request being denied or payment delayed.

Attendance and Punctuality

The well-operation of the agency depends on the employee's reliability and punctuality reporting to work. Absenteeism and tardiness place a burden on the agency, other employees and third parties. We expect all employees to arrive at the work station at least five minutes prior to the beginning of their shifts. It is understood that employees who report to work three minutes after the beginning of their shift are considered late. Employees who are excessively late or absent from work will be disciplined accordingly. Guidelines about the Attendance and Punctuality:

- If an employee is absent from work for one day without giving notice to the agency, it is considered that the employee has voluntarily resigned.
- If an employee missed three (3) consecutive days of work due an illness, a note from a treating physician must be submitted before the employee can return to work.
- If an employee report to work in a condition not deemed unsuitable to complete the essential duties for one reason or another, the employee will be sent home and will not be allowed to return to work until a formal approval from the Human Resources Department.
- If an employee leaves work before the end of the shift without notifying the immediate supervisor, it is considered that the employee has voluntarily resigned.

Dress Code/Appearance and Hygiene

Employees' personal appearance affects the overall image of the agency in the community. Therefore, FLH expects all employees to maintain (a) neat appearance when at work. Employees

must wear clean clothes and clothing shall be free of provocative or obscene writing or pictures. Personal attire should not be excessively baggy or too tight. See through clothes and scrubs are not permitted. Shorts, skirts and dresses must be at knee level. Sleeveless tops and sleepwear are prohibited and pants must be worn at the waistline. The use of jewelries that are loosen or dangling is strongly discouraged as it can be create safety problems. Only closed toed shoes and low-heeled shoes are permitted to be worn in the consumers' homes.

Failure to follow the above listed personal appearance and hygiene guidelines will result in the employee removal from shift. Employees who get sent home for failing to follow personal appearance and hygiene guidelines shall not receive compensation for the time away from work and will be subject to corrective action, up to and including termination of employment.

Phone and Electronic Device Use

The purpose of the phone and electronic device use policy is to establish rules and guidelines regarding the use of personal mobile phones and gadgets, consumer's home phones and agency owned electronic equipment.

Personal phone calls are not to be made when employees are on shift. Only emergency calls are permitted to be made; however, caution must be exercised. The following guidelines must be adhered to when an employee is making/receiving personal calls:

- The number of calls must be limited and calls must be short.
- Employees must move to a location away from consumer and coworkers.
- Charges incurred for unauthorized calls made on the consumers' phone will be charged to the employees' account.

An employee who has been found in violation of this policy will be disciplined, up to and including termination of employment. Unauthorized use of consumer's phone can lead to criminal prosecution.

Documentation policy

Documentation is essential and vital to the interest of our business. Accurate documentation must be collected on daily basis, during each shift and in a timely manner. The responsibility falls on employees to monitor the consumers and record their daily progress on the tracking log.

In a case where an employee fails to document accurately, the employee will be notified by his/her immediate supervisor. The employee will then make every effort to resolve the issue by the end of the day the notification was received. Failing to document accurately and/or in a timely manner constitutes a misconduct and the employee will be subject to corrective action, up to and including termination of employment.

Controlled Substance and Alcohol Policy

FLH has zero-tolerance policy for controlled substances and alcohol abuse. FLH does not complete pre-employment drug testing; however, drug testing is completed randomly during the time of employment. Employees will be required to complete drug testing based on the following criteria:

1. Reasonable suspicion: if an employee is suspected of being under the influence of drug/alcohol, consuming alcohol or using drug while on duty.
2. Post-Accident: if an employee is involved in a vehicle accident while on duty, the employee will be subject to a mandatory drug screening to determine if alcohol/drug was a contributing factor.

Any refusal to submit to testing or any attempt to tamper with a sample will result in termination. Employees who tested positive for illegal drug use at any time during their employment with FLH will automatically be terminated.

Work related injury sustained as a result of drug/alcohol use or refusing to submit to drug testing may be disqualified for compensation under the Workers' Compensation Act. If an employee tested positive for drug/alcohol screen, it is the employee's responsibility to dispute and prove that the presence of alcohol or the controlled substance was not the proximate cause of the work-related injury. For the safety of the consumers and the community we serve, FLH encourages employees not to report to duty or remaining on duty while under the influence of alcohol or controlled substance.

HIPAA Law and Confidentiality Policy

Safeguarding confidential information is vital to the interest and success of the agency. FLH is required by law to maintain the privacy of consumers and employees' Protected Health Information (PHI). We are required to provide employees with a copy of a notice of our privacy practices and provide interested parties when changes are made to the privacy policy. FLH follows the federal Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA) regulations.

We ask employees to respect consumers' privacy. Employee must not discuss consumers' PHI outside of the workplace and with other employees who are not directly involved in the care of the consumers. Confidential information includes but is not limited to: demographic information, medical information, home address, phone number, compensation and benefits data.

Complaints or questions about HIPAA rules should be addressed to the Human Resources department.

Any disclosure of consumers' PHI to unauthorized party constitutes a violation of the HIPAA law and agency policy. Any disclosure of confidential information will be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

Major Unusual Incident

A major unusual incident (MUI) is defined as any alleged, suspected, or actual occurrence of an incident that adversely affects the health and safety of an individual. All the incidents require that:

- An immediate action be taken to protect individuals from further harm.
- An investigation is conducted to determine the cause of the incident and contributing factors.
- A prevention plan is developed to reduce the likelihood of further occurrences.

All employees who have a reason to believe that an individual has suffered or faced any sort of abuse are mandated to report immediately. Failure to report the following:

- Neglect
- Physical abuse
- Sexual abuse
- Verbal abuse
- Exploitation/misappropriation

will result in corrective action or termination of employment.

Unusual Incidents are events which are not consistent with individuals' daily routine operations, or Individual Service Plan, but it not an MUI. Unusual Incidents are different from Major Unusual Incidents in a way that they do not cause major health and safety risk to the individual.

Visitation Policy

Employees are not permitted to have visitors at the workplace. All visitors who must be in a consumer's home must have prior visitation authorization. Drop-in visitations are forbidden and all guests must adhere to FLH visitation standards of conduct during the time of the visit. Former staff members are not permitted to visit or be on the premises without prior authorization

from Human Resources. Visitation may be limited to specific times and at the discretion of Human Resources.

Staff who have unauthorized guests at work will be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment. Misconducts by guests must be reported immediately to the supervisor and police must be directly called if the presence of the visitor represents a threat/harm to health and safety to a consumer.

Smoking Free Policy

FLH has zero-tolerance policy for smoking on its premises. Employees who are found guilty of this policy will be subject to corrective action, up to and including termination of employment.

Disciplinary Actions and Retraining

Counseling and disciplinary actions are progressive steps taken by the agency to ensure compliance with its policies, tackle a problem, or to prevent an unacceptable or inappropriate behavior from reoccurring. The following are the disciplinary steps:

1. Verbal warning
2. Written warning
3. Final warning
4. Termination

Retraining is a guidance process to advise an employee about an issue of a minor issue that is likely to become misconduct. When deemed necessary, an employee may be disciplined in place of retraining and a disciplinary step may be skipped depending on the severity of the misconduct.

Misconduct

Misconduct are unacceptable behaviors and employees will be subject to corrective action up to and including termination of employment. The following are examples of unacceptable or inappropriate conduct that may result in immediate corrective action, suspension, up to and including termination of employment.

1. Violating consumer's rights and alone time policy.
2. Sleeping on duty during direct care hours (HPC hours).
3. Unauthorized relationship with consumer and accepting gifts from a consumer.
4. Failing to follow the consumer's plans or administering unapproved behavior support.
5. Unauthorized operation of FLH vehicles.
6. Unauthorized transportation of residents in personal vehicles.

7. Failing to attend mandatory training class or maintain license/certification.
8. Failing to report a conviction
9. Taking actions that are or can be deemed detrimental to the agency
10. Making threat, instigating a fight or fighting
11. Violating dress code policy
12. Unauthorized absence from work station for any personal reason
13. Failing to report an accident or injury involving staff or resident.
14. Smoking on the premises operated by FLH
15. Stealing or intentionally damaging company and/or consumers' property.
16. Being in possession of a weapon or explosive device while on duty.
17. Being in possession of illegal substances while at on duty.
18. Being in an impaired condition while on duty.
19. Causing harm to a coworker and/or a third party at work or traceable to work.
20. Falsifying company records and/or violating confidentiality policies
21. Failing to follow company safety policies and/or procedures.
22. Inappropriate conduct toward a coworker and/or a third party.
23. Making false statements concerning the company.
24. Failing to comply with Controlled Substance and Alcohol Policy
25. Failing to cooperate with an ongoing investigation
26. Violating of the workplace bullying policy and sexual harassment policies.
27. Excessive absenteeism or tardiness and Unauthorized shift switch.
28. Failing to maintain required level of supervision
29. Health related activity errors.
30. Insubordination and/or Neglect of Duty.

This list is not all-inclusive and employees may be disciplined, suspended or dismissed for actions not specifically shown on the list. Employees will be disciplined based on the severity of the offense, the existence of prior offenses, trends and pattern of prior offenses. Employees may be subject to immediate dismissal upon the first offense.

Suspension/ Inactive Status

Suspension is not a stand-alone disciplinary action, but can be used as a form of a corrective action. There are several reasons which might lead to an employee being placed on inactive status (suspended). An employee may become inactive for the following reasons:

- Pending the finding of an agency initiated investigation.
- At the request of the county MUI Unit, state or federal law enforcement agency.
- When an employee fails to renew required certifications, driver license and attend annual refresher classes.
- When an employee fails to provide vehicle insurance policy documentation

An employee who has been suspended for one reason or another will remain on inactive status until granted formal written permission to return to work. If an employee returns to work after a

period of inactivity, the employee may elect to use available vacation and personal time to receive compensation for the time off work based on the outcome of the investigation. Employee who are terminated following a period of inactive status will not receive any compensation for the time off work.

Harassment Prevention Policy

The harassment prevention policy is put in place to prevent harassment at the work place by supervisors or coworkers. Harassment of any kind is not permitted on any premises operated by FLH. Harassment is defined as an unwelcome conduct based on gender, sexual preference, race, color, religion, national origin, age, mental or physical disability, veteran status that adversely affects and interferes with an employee's work performance.

FLH prohibits verbal, physical or visual conducts which may disrupt if not interferes with the work performance or productivity of another employee. Employees who display conduct that is pervasive enough to be construed in the work environment as intimidating, hostile, offensive or abusive will be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination. In case of questionable conduct by a coworker or a third party, the employee has the duty to report the misconduct to the Human Resources department. Employee who make false accusations of harassment will be disciplined or dismissed.

Family and Medical Leave (FMLA)

The Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA) of 1993 requires that leave be granted to eligible employees for the following:

- To care for the employee's child after birth, or placement for adoption or foster care.
- To care for the employee's spouse, son or daughter, or parent, who has a serious health condition.
- For a serious health condition that makes the employee unable to perform the essential job functions.

To be eligible for FMLA, an employee must have completed at least twelve months of service with FLH, worked 1,250 hours in the twelve months immediately preceding the start of the leave and an employee must be employed at a worksite where 50 or more employees are employed within 75 miles of that worksite.

An eligible employee is entitled to take up to twelve weeks of leave during each twelve (12) month period. There are three types of Leave:

- A continuous leave occurs when the employee is absent from work all day, every day for a period of up to twelve weeks.

- An intermittent leave is taken in separate blocks of time due to a single qualifying reason and may include leave periods as short as one hour.
- A reduced leave schedule reduces an employee's usual number of working hours per workday or workweek.

In order to fulfill the agency's staffing needs, an employee on intermittent or reduced leave shall schedule leave and may be temporarily transferred to an alternative position with equivalent pay and benefits for the duration of the leave.

The FMLA leave application along with the medical documentation related to the leave must be submitted to the Human Resources as soon as the need to take FMLA is known.

The employee's group health insurance will be continued during the term of the FMLA on the same basis; however, the employee must continue to make any contributions that he/she made to the plan before taking leave or lose health insurance coverage.

Employees must provide Human Resources with a return to work note from their physician prior to going back to work. FLH will seek to accommodate employees who are restricted to limited duties by reassigning them; however, it is understood that reassignment might not always be possible.

Employees who take FMLA will be paid for their accrued vacation and personal until they are all exhausted. Employees who fail to return to work upon the expiration of a family or medical leave of absence, will subject to immediate termination unless an application for extension is granted. Employees who need FMLA extension must submit a request to the Human Resources department as soon as the need is known.

Personal Leave of Absence

A Leave of Absence is granted to accommodate employees who do not meet the eligibility requirements for FMLA, but needed a period of time away from work. Request for personal leave is only granted at the discretion of the agency. Employees who do not qualify for FMLA, but need time off work must apply for personal leave by addressing a written request to the Human Resources. All requests for personal leave must be submitted at least thirty days before the beginning of leave.

Person Leave of absence requests are granted on a case by case basis and FLH takes into consideration the following factors to make a decision: reason of the request, length of employment, staffing needs and performance record. The agency reserves the right to approve only part of the request or deny it entirely. Employees who fail to return to work at the end of the leave period will be considered to have voluntarily resigned. Employees who are granted personal leave will use all accrued personal and vacation time if available.

Military Leave of Absence

FLH recognizes the needs of employees who are members of the armed forces to return to active duty. Under the Uniformed Services Employment and Reemployment Rights Act (USERRA) employees who voluntarily or involuntarily leave employment positions to undertake military service or certain types of service in the National Disaster Medical System have the right to be reemployed in their position if they leave to perform service in the uniformed service. Employees who take time off work to return to active duty will have the position guaranteed upon returning from serving given that the employee provide Human Resources with a copy of military leave notice in a timely manner and return to work or apply for reemployment right after returning from serving in the military.

Employees and their dependents will be offered Consolidated Omnibus Budget Reconciliation Act (COBRA) coverage for up to 24 months while in the military. Employees who return from serving in the military have the right to be reinstated in the agency's offered health plan upon return to work.

Continuation of Health Coverage (COBRA)

COBRA gives employees and their qualified beneficiaries the opportunity to continue coverage under the agency's medical, dental and vision plan when a "qualifying event" would normally result in a loss of your benefits. Some qualifying events would be resignation, termination of employment, death of an employee, a reduction in employee's hours or in some cases, leave of absence, an employee's divorce and a dependent child who no longer meets eligibility requirements.

Under COBRA, the employee and the beneficiary(s) pay the full cost of the coverage at the agency's group rates plus an administration fee. The agency will provide employee with written information describing rights and obligations granted under COBRA. Employees should refer to Human Resources for more information about COBRA.

Workers' compensation

All employees are covered under the Ohio's Workers' Compensation law for time loss and on-the-job related injury. Employees who cannot work due to work related injury or illness for fourteen days or more are eligible to receive benefits under the Ohio workers' compensation law. Employees who are injured at work, whether minor or severe must report the incident to their immediate supervisor and notify the Human Resources department as soon as possible. Employees are required to complete a written Employee's Report of Incident no later than twenty-four hours after being injured and fill out all necessary workers' compensation documents.

All related documents to workers' compensation can be obtained from the Human Resources department. Employees who fail to complete workers' compensation documents in a timely manner may delay the processing of their claim or have their claim denied.

Jury Duty

FLH acknowledges the necessity for employees to perform city duties. When an employee received a summons in connection with a judicial proceeding by a court for jury duty, the agency will take necessary step to relieve the employee from duties. An employee summoned for jury duty must notify the supervisor immediately so that arrangement can be made to allow the employee to report to court. FLH does not provide reimbursement to employees for jury service. Employees who have accrued personal time and vacation time may elect to use them to receive compensation for the time away from work. To receive compensation for time missed, the employee must submit a document to Human Resources proving he/she served as a juror in a court proceeding.

Bereavement

This bereavement policy is established to allow employees to take time off work for the death of an immediate family member. Immediate family is parents, grandparents, spouse, siblings or children. FLH offers employees three days of unpaid bereavement leave or the option to use personal time, vacation or the combination of both if available to be compensated. Supporting documentation may be requested to prove relationship with the deceased person to qualify for compensation. Employees should complete the time off request form and turn it into the Human Resources department. Employees who take time off work due to the death of a family member, but fail to provide necessary documentation may be subject to corrective action.

EMPLOYEE ACKNOWLEDGEMENT FORM

I, _____ acknowledge that I have received a copy of the Frontline Healthcare Employee Handbook and acknowledge that it contains important information about the agency's policies and code of conduct. I understand that I am governed by the contents of the Employee Handbook and that I am expected to read, understand, familiarize myself with and comply with the policies contained in it.

I also understand that the agency may change, rescind or add to any of the policies, benefits or practices described in the Employee Handbook in its sole and absolute discretion, with or without prior notice. The agency will advise employees from time to time of material changes to the policies, benefits or practices described in the Employee Handbook.

Furthermore, I agree that the Employee Handbook is not a contract of employment, that my employment with the agency is not for a specified term and that employment with the agency is at the mutual consent of the employee and the agency. Therefore, I hereby acknowledge that either I, or the agency can terminate my employment relationship at will, with or without cause or notice.

By signing below, I agree to the terms and conditions described in the manual and agree to abide by them during my time of employment with Frontline Healthcare.

Employee Name: _____

Date: _____

Employee Signature: _____

Witness signature _____

Date _____

EMPLOYEE COPY TO REMAIN IN HANDBOOK